

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

SOUL: IMMORTALITY, REBIRTH AND LIBERATION - Layered Solved-Practice Workbook - Philosophy Paper II Philosophy of Religion 04

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

PHILOSOPHY PAPER II | PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION 04

SOUL: IMMORTALITY, REBIRTH AND LIBERATION

SIX TERMS THAT MUST NEVER BE MERGED - WESTERN & INDIAN SOTERIOLOGY

IMMORTALITY -> REBIRTH -> LIBERATION : is each NECESSARY for the next? Buddhism = rebirth WITHOUT an immortal soul

WESTERN

immortality vs resurrection

- Plato (Phaedo): 4 a priori proofs
opposites - recollection - affinity - Form of Life
- soul naturally deathless, akin to Forms
- Kant: soul not a knowable substance
- Resurrection (Semitic): one life,
psychosomatic person raised by God
- identity: replica (Hick) / gap /
re-assembly (van Inwagen)
- Cullmann: immortality vs resurrection OPPOSED

INDIAN

eternal self vs no-self

- Vedanta: atman eternal -> moksha
Advaita identity | Visistadvaita communion
- Nyaya-Vaisesika: eternal self -> apavarga
- Samkhya-Yoga: purusa isolated -> kaivalya
- Jaina: eternal jiva -> kevala/siddhatva
asrava-bandha-samvara-nirjara
- Buddhism: anatman -> nirvana
rebirth as causal stream (flame-to-flame)
- karma + punarjanma drive the cycle

MOKSHA

Advaita: identity

APAVARGA

Nyaya: cessation

KAIVALYA

Samkhya: isolation

NIRVANA

Buddhism: cessation, no self

KEVALA

Jaina: perfected soul

Liberation is a family-resemblance term: identity, communion, isolation, cessation and perfected individuality - never one state

Provenance: Gita 2.22/2.23/18.66; Bhagavata 7.5.23; Samkhya-karika 62-63/67-68; Yoga-sutra 1.24; Hick replica; Cullmann 1955; van Inwagen. Diacritics normalised on cover only.

Owens exactly 17 Philosophy of Religion PYQ parts, 2018-2025 (2.1:2.3:3.2:2.2). Six survival-terms kept distinct.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

SOUL: IMMORTALITY, REBIRTH AND LIBERATION - Layered Solved-Practice Workbook - Philosophy Paper II Philosophy of Religion 04

Workbook Source Audit

- Exact PYQ wording, year and marks: local Philosophy of Religion Paper II bank, 2018-2025.
- Exactly 17 owner questions (2018:2, 2019:1, 2020:2, 2021:3, 2022:3, 2023:2, 2024:2, 2025:2).
- Ownership discipline: Indian Philosophy Paper I questions that merely mention moksha or soul are kept separate; the six survival-terms (immortality, rebirth, reincarnation, resurrection, liberation, and the liberation-terms moksha/apavarga/kaivalya/nirvana/kevala) are kept distinct throughout.
- Model solutions authored at examiner grade: thesis -> named source / verse / argument -> analysis -> objection/reply -> verdict, each closing with a "Why this earns marks" note.
- MCQs: 40 core plus 8 remedial, exactly 48, strict A-B-C-D rotation twelve times.
- Original Mains: one solved 10-marker, one solved 15-marker and one solved 20-marker.
- Provenance discipline observed throughout (Gita 2.22/2.23/18.66; Bhagavata 7.5.23; Samkhya-karika 62-63/67-68; Yoga-sutra 1.24; Hick replica theory; Cullmann 1955; van Inwagen; disputed Vivekacudamani ascription flagged).
- Supplementary book depth attributed to the Oxford Handbook of Philosophy of Religion where used.
- No current-affairs anchor is used (no verified 2026 development found); relevance is static and syllabus-driven.
- Final consolidated register notes are intentionally excluded from this workbook.

Practice Design

The workbook sequence is the seventeen exact verified PYQs -> 40 core MCQs -> 8 remedial MCQs -> original 10/15/20-mark Mains practice. There are no register notes and no canonical apparatus block in this workbook.

DIRECTIVE -> THESIS -> DOCTRINE -> NAMED SOURCE / EXAMPLE -> OBJECTION / REPLY -> VERDICT

SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 17 VERIFIED OWNER QUESTIONS

Exact wording, year and marks are parsed from the continuous local Philosophy of Religion Paper II bank for 2018-2025. This clause owns exactly 17 primary parts (2018:2, 2019:1, 2020:2, 2021:3, 2022:3, 2023:2, 2024:2, 2025:2). Ownership discipline: Indian Philosophy Paper I questions that merely mention moksha or soul are NOT counted here.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q5(b), 10 marks

Question: How far is it plausible to argue that the anti-theistic religions' stand on the concept of rebirth is philosophically significant?

Model solution

Thesis. The anti-theistic religions (Buddhism, and in its own way Jainism) are philosophically significant precisely because they show that rebirth is detachable both from a creator-God and from an immortal soul-substance.

- **Doctrine.** Buddhism affirms re-becoming (*punarbhava*) while denying a permanent self (*anatman*): what continues is a dependently arisen causal stream, not a transmigrating substance. Jainism has an eternal *jiva* but no God who administers karma; the moral law is self-regulating.

- **Significance (three claims).** (1) Karma needs no divine judge -- desert is discharged by an impersonal law, answering the problem of evil differently from theism. (2) Rebirth needs no immortal soul -- continuity, not substance, suffices (the flame-to-flame model). (3) Liberation (*nirvana*, *kevala*) requires neither grace nor union with God.

- **Objection -> reply.** If nothing permanent persists, who is reborn and who is

liberated? Reply: the later stream is "neither the same nor wholly other"; moral responsibility rests on causal connectedness, not identity of substance.

Verdict. The stand is significant because it separates the *machinery* of karma-rebirth-liberation from theism and from soul-substance, proving that the Indian moral cosmos is not logically wedded to either.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it reads "significant" as a modal/structural claim (what rebirth does NOT require) rather than as praise, and names the exact anti-substantialist and anti-theistic points.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2018 Q7(c), 15 marks

Question: Evaluate the concept of Bhakti (Devotion) as a pathway to attain liberation.

Model solution

Thesis. Bhakti is a complete path to liberation in the theistic Vedantas and a preparatory discipline in Advaita; its philosophical contribution is structural -- it relocates liberation from achievement to reception.

- **Define the criterion.** A "pathway" must be assessed for accessibility, sufficiency and terminus -- not merely described.
- **Textual base.** *Gita* 18.66 (*carama-sloka*: abandon all dharmas, take refuge in Me alone), 9.22 and 9.32 on accessibility; *Bhagavata* 7.5.23 lists the nine limbs (*navadha bhakti*): *sravana*, *kirtana*, *smarana*, *pada-sevana*, *arcana*, *vandana*, *dasya*, *sakhya*, *atma-nivedana*.
- **Typology (marks lie here).** *para* vs *apara*; *vaidhi* vs *raganuga*; *saguna* (Tulsidas, Mira) vs *nirguna* (Kabir, Nanak) -- the latter showing

bhakti needs a personal focus, not an iconic form.

- **Systematic positions.** Ramanuja: bhakti as *dhruvanusmrti*, with *prapatti* as the accessible alternative; grace decisive; *marjara* vs *markata* dispute on grace/effort. Madhva: *jnana-purvaka-sneha*. Caitanya: *prema* as a fifth *purusartha*. Advaita: bhakti is *citta-suddhi*, preparatory not liberating.

- **Objection -> reply.** Love presupposes duality, so bhakti cannot deliver Advaitic identity -> Advaita agrees and so classes it as means, not end; the theistic schools deny identity is the goal at all.

Verdict. Bhakti's significance is not emotional but structural: it makes moksha a matter of grace (reception) rather than qualification (achievement).

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- criterion-first evaluation, precise verse citation in order, the grace/effort dispute named, and the achievement-> reception thesis stated explicitly.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2019 Q8(a), 20 marks

Question: State and explain the doctrines of Karma, Rebirth and Reincarnation in Hinduism.

Model solution

Thesis. Karma, rebirth and reincarnation are linked but non-identical: karma is the mechanism, rebirth the field, and "reincarnation" a school-specific substantialist reading that Buddhism refuses. Define each before expounding.

- **Karma.** Act together with its unseen potency (*adrsta/apurva*); classified as *sancita* (stored), *prarabdha* (ripening now) and *agami* (future). It is moral causation, not fatalism -- *purusakara* (effort) operates within *daiva*.
- **Rebirth.** *Punarjanma* within beginningless *samsara*; the subtle body (*suksma-sarira*) carries *samskaras* across lives. *Gita* 2.22 (worn-out garments) and 9.21 (return from heaven when merit is exhausted) show even heaven is a within-*samsara* stage.
- **Reincarnation vs rebirth.** Reincarnation (*re-enfleshing*) presupposes a SUBSTANTIAL soul re-entering a body (Vedanta, Nyaya, Jainism). Rebirth is the wider, neutral term and the ONLY correct one for Buddhism's *punarbhava* without a transmigrating self.

- **Contrast.** Resurrection -- one life, divine re-constitution, final judgement

(Cullmann's opposition of Greek immortality and Hebrew resurrection).

- **Criticism -> reply.** Memory objection and victim-blaming risk; reply -- memory is not continuity, and karma explains without licensing social blame.

Verdict. Karma supplies the mechanism, rebirth the field, and reincarnation a substantialist reading of that field which Buddhism rejects.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it obeys "state AND explain" by defining all three separately, then interlocking them, and it nails the reincarnation/rebirth distinction the question is built to test.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2020 Q5(b), 10 marks

Question: The concept of 'Immortality' is a basic presupposition of religion. Elaborate your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. Immortality functions as a basic presupposition of religion because most traditions require some post-mortem continuant to bear desert, judgement or liberation -- but the presupposition takes at least three different forms, and Buddhism shows it is not strictly necessary.

- **Why presupposed.** Moral seriousness (desert beyond this life), the hope of liberation/salvation, and the meaningfulness of ritual for the dead all seem to need something that survives death.

- **Three forms.** (1) Greek/Platonic natural immortality of a simple soul; (2) Semitic resurrection, where the psychosomatic person is re-constituted by God (not a natural property but a divine act -- Cullmann, 1955); (3) Indian eternal *atman/jiva* transmigrating until liberation.

- **The counter-example.** Buddhism grounds desert and liberation on a causal stream (*anatman*), so immortality is a common but not indispensable presupposition -- continuity is what is really required.

Verdict. "Immortality" is a widespread and structurally important presupposition of religion, but the deeper presupposition is CONTINUITY of a morally accountable subject, which Buddhism secures without an immortal soul.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it elaborates the claim (as asked) but refuses to overclaim, distinguishing the forms of the presupposition and citing the Buddhist limiting case.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2020 Q8(c), 15 marks

Question: Do you accept that Knowledge, Action and Devotion are the means to attain liberation in Indian tradition? Discuss.

Model solution

Thesis. Knowledge, action and devotion are all means to liberation, but means of DIFFERENT kinds; whether they are alternative, sequential or combined is settled by a prior question -- is liberation produced or uncovered?

- **Apparatus (deploy early).** Direct means (*saksat-sadhana*) vs remote aid (*arad-upakaraka*); means vs qualification (*adhikara*); production model vs

removal model of moksa.

- **Positions.** *Purva-Mimamsa*: karma alone (the *purvapaksa*). *Sankara*: jnana alone removes *avidya*; he rejects *jnana-karma-samuccaya*; karma and *upasana*

only purify (*sadhana-catustaya*; *sravana-manana-nididhyasana*). *Ramanuja*: karma -> jnana -> bhakti, with *prapatti* as the accessible alternative -- a graded *samuccaya*. *Madhva*: knowledge-grounded bhakti, *prasada* decisive.

- **The Gita's signal.** 5.4-5: only the immature call Samkhya (knowledge) and

Yoga (action) different -- which is why Sankara, Ramanuja and Tilak could each claim the text. Vivekananda's four yogas match temperament (psychological, not metaphysical, pluralism).

- **Objection -> reply.** "Convergence" is diplomatic mush -> reply: they converge

in FUNCTION (removing egoic self-appropriation) but diverge in TERMINUS (identity vs communion); say this rather than harmonising.

Verdict. Karma qualifies, bhakti receives, jnana removes; their relation follows from each school's answer to whether liberation is produced or uncovered.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it names the disagreement instead of harmonising, and uses the production/removal cut to explain WHY schools differ.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2021 Q6(a), 20 marks

Question: Discuss the concept of immortality of soul with special reference to Hindu tradition.

Model solution

Thesis. In the Hindu tradition the immortality of the soul is affirmed across schools, but on different grounds and with different consequences for liberation; it is best read as the eternity of a continuity-bearer rather than one uniform doctrine.

- **Vedanta.** The *atman* is eternal and self-luminous; *Gita* 2.23 gives the canonical image that weapons, fire, water and wind cannot destroy the embodied self. Advaita: *atman* = Brahman; Visistadvaita: the *jiva* is an eternal mode of God.

- **Nyaya-Vaisesika.** The self is an eternal substance, but consciousness is adventitious to it -- hence *apavarga* is cessation of pain and of consciousness.

- **Samkhya-Yoga.** *Purusa* is eternal, plural, contentless witness, isolated by nature (*kevala*).

- **Comparison with the West.** Plato argues immortality a priori (Phaedo); the Hindu case rests on scriptural testimony and substance-metaphysics, not on the Forms.

- **Critique -> reply.** The soul's simplicity does not entail indestructibility (Kant's paralogism), and there is no memory of past lives -> reply: continuity is carried by *samskaras* in the subtle body, distinct from psychological memory.

Verdict. Hindu "immortality of the soul" is the eternity of a continuity-bearer (*atman/jiva/purusa*), variously conceived, and it grounds -- but does not by itself deliver -- liberation.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it keeps "Hindu tradition" plural (Vedanta, Nyaya, Samkhya) instead of collapsing it, and cites the verified *Gita* 2.23 image.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2021 Q6(b), 15 marks

Question: Elucidate the concept of liberation according to Advaita Vedānta. Explain the role of knowledge in the attainment of liberation.

Model solution

Thesis. For Advaita, liberation (*moksa*) is the realisation of the *atman*'s identity with Brahman through the removal of ignorance (*avidya*); knowledge (*jnana*) is therefore the sole direct means.

- **Nature of liberation.** *Moksa* is not a producible effect but the eternally accomplished nature of the self, obscured by *avidya*. It comes as *jivanmukti*

(freedom while living, the body coasting on *prarabdha* like a spun wheel) and *videhamukti* (at the body's fall).

- **Role of knowledge.** Since bondage is ignorance, only knowledge can remove it, as light removes darkness. Sankara rejects *jnana-karma-samuccaya*; action and *upasana* generate *citta-suddhi* and the *sadhana-catustaya*, and knowledge matures through *sravana-manana-nididhyasana*.

- **Provenance (Griffiths).** Bondage is a beginningless superimposition

(*adhyasa*) -- the rope taken for a snake -- so *moksa* is "not acquired but acknowledged"; knowledge only removes the error.

- **Objection -> reply.** If knowledge destroys karma, why does the body remain?

-> already-fructifying *prarabdha* is distinguished from accumulated and future karma.

Verdict. Advaitic liberation is a cognitive-existential awakening, and knowledge is the direct means because liberation is uncovered, not produced.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it answers BOTH obligations (the concept AND the role of knowledge), and grounds the "knowledge alone" claim in the removal model.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2021 Q8(b), 15 marks

Question: Discuss and evaluate the doctrine of Karma as an essential postulate of Hinduism.

Model solution

Thesis. The doctrine of karma is an essential postulate of Hinduism because it supplies a self-regulating moral order that makes rebirth intelligible and desert just; it is defensible against fatalism and moral-luck objections but remains empirically unverifiable.

- **Statement.** Every morally qualified act leaves an unseen potency

(*adrsta/apurva*) that matures as pleasure or pain; *sancita/prarabdha/agami* classify the debt. Karma requires rebirth, since fruits mature beyond one life.

- **Why a postulate.** It grounds moral responsibility, explains the distribution of fortune without a capricious deity, and secures the justice of *samsara*.

- **Evaluation.** Strength -- it is not fatalism: *purusakara* operates within *daiva*; present effort shapes *agami*.

Weakness -- unverifiability, and the moral-luck/victim-blaming risk.

- **Objection -> reply.** Karma blames the sufferer -> reply: it EXPLAINS distribution without LICENSING social judgement; compassion remains obligatory.

Verdict. Karma is postulated because it does indispensable work -- justice, responsibility, the intelligibility of rebirth -- but its warrant is inferential and moral, not empirical.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it both expounds AND evaluates (as asked), defending karma against fatalism while conceding unverifiability.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2022 Q5(c), 10 marks

Question: "Immortality of Soul is a necessary postulate for rebirth." Critically examine with reference to Buddhism.

Model solution

Thesis. The claim that immortality of the soul is a necessary postulate for rebirth is false as stated: a persisting soul is SUFFICIENT for rebirth but not NECESSARY, and Buddhism is the decisive counter-example.

- **The substantialist assumption.** In Vedanta, Nyaya and Jainism an eternal *atman/jiva* is exactly what transmigrates, so there immortality is presupposed.

- **The Buddhist refutation.** Buddhism denies a permanent self (*anatman*) yet affirms rebirth (*punarbhava*): what continues is a dependently arisen causal

stream, illustrated by a flame passing candle to candle. Rebirth therefore requires CONTINUITY, not an unchanging substance.

- **Objection -> reply.** If no same agent persists, who is reborn and who reaps the fruit? -> the later stream is "neither the same nor wholly other"; moral responsibility rests on causal connectedness.

Verdict. Immortality of a substantial soul is sufficient but not necessary for rebirth; what rebirth strictly needs is a continuity-bearer, and schools disagree only about whether that bearer must be a substance. Buddhism proves the point.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it delivers a precise MODAL verdict (sufficient not necessary) and uses Buddhism as a counter-example, not merely an exception.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2022 Q7(b), 15 marks

Question: Is it possible to have an idea of Liberation without the conception of a real agent? In this context, discuss the difference between Advaita and Viśiṣṭādvaita systems of thought.

Model solution

Thesis. An idea of liberation without a "real agent" is coherent, and the Advaita-Visistadvaita dispute is exactly a dispute over whether the liberated subject is an ultimately real individual agent.

- **The paradox.** If Advaita denies ultimate individuality, who is bound and who is liberated?

- **Advaita.** *Moksa* is the sublation of a MISTAKEN individuality, not the annihilation of an entity; conventional agency (*vyavaharika*) operates until

liberating knowledge removes the misidentification. The "agent" is real empirically, unreal absolutely -- so liberation needs no ultimately real agent.

- **Visistadvaita.** The *jiva* is a real, eternal mode of God, a genuine agent throughout, bound by karma and freed into communion/service; it never becomes God. So it faces no agent-paradox but pays with irreducible plurality.

- **Objection -> reply.** Advaita's conventional agency looks ad hoc -> reply: the two-truths framework is doing principled work, distinguishing the standpoint of ignorance from that of realisation.

Verdict. Liberation without a real (ultimate) agent is coherent on Advaita and denied on Visistadvaita; the difference is not about liberation's possibility but about the ontological status of the one who is free.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it reframes the "real agent" question as the very axis dividing the two schools, giving each its own answer rather than blending.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2022 Q8(b), 15 marks

Question: Discuss the nature of Soul and Bondage according to Jainism.

Model solution

Thesis. In Jainism the soul (*jiva*) is an eternal, conscious substance whose bondage is the literal adhesion of fine karmic MATTER; liberation is the complete stoppage and shedding of that matter.

- **Nature of the soul.** Every living being is an eternal conscious *jiva*, of the size of the body it occupies, whose intrinsic nature is infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and energy (*ananta-catustaya*), currently obscured.

- **Bondage machinery.** Passions and action ATTRACT karmic particles (*asrava*); they BIND to the soul (*bandha*); restraint STOPS the influx (*samvara*); austerity SHEDS accumulated karma (*nirjara*); the freed *jiva* manifests its full qualities and rises to the summit of the universe (*siddhatva*).

- **Distinction.** Jain liberation PERFECTS individuality -- neither Advaitic identity nor Buddhist cessation without a self. Jain *kevala* = omniscience, not Samkhya's contentless *kaivalya*.

- **Objection -> reply.** How does non-material consciousness interact with quasi-material karma? -> Jainism treats extension and embodiment as MODES of the *jiva* during bondage; the reply is contested but internally consistent.

Verdict. The Jain soul is eternal and intrinsically omniscient, and bondage/ liberation are a quasi-physical process of accretion and removal of karmic matter.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it delivers BOTH nouns the question names (soul AND bondage), with the *asrava-bandha-samvara-nirjara* machinery in order.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2023 Q6(a), 20 marks

Question: Critically examine Plato's apriori proofs for the immortality of the soul.

Model solution

Thesis. Plato's four Phaedo arguments make the soul's immortality suggestive but not demonstrable; assessed separately, each either reaches only pre-existence or rests on an undefended assumption.

- **(1) Opposites (cyclical).** Living and dead arise from each other, so souls persist between lives. *Assessment:* establishes recurrence, not the soul's indestructibility; the analogy from physical opposites is weak.
- **(2) Recollection (anamnesis).** We judge equal sticks by an Equality never perfectly given in sense, so the soul knew it before birth. *Assessment:* proves (at most) PRE-existence, not post-mortem survival.
- **(3) Affinity.** The soul is simple, invisible and akin to the Forms, so it does not decompose. *Assessment:* likeness is not identity; simplicity does not entail indestructibility.
- **(4) Form of Life.** The soul essentially brings Life and cannot admit its opposite, death. *Assessment:* the strongest, but it assumes the soul is essentially life-giving -- the point at issue.
- **Objection -> reply.** Simmias' harmony analogy makes the soul a bodily attunement -> Plato replies the soul RULES the body and pre-exists it.
- **External critique.** Kant's paralogism: the soul is not a knowable substance.

Verdict. The arguments are mutually supporting rather than individually conclusive; they render immortality intelligible, not proven.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- "critically examine" is obeyed by FOUR separate assessments plus Simmias and Kant, not one summary verdict.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2023 Q7(b), 15 marks

Question: Examine the significance of the concept of rebirth in the theory of Karma.

Model solution

Thesis. Rebirth is not an optional appendage to the theory of karma but its enabling condition: without further lives, karma's justice -- fruits maturing beyond a single lifetime -- would be impossible.

- **The link.** Karma is act plus unseen potency (*adrsta/apurva*); much of it (*sancita, agami*) matures only in future lives. Rebirth is the FIELD in which those fruits ripen, so karmic desert requires a continued series.
- **Continuity-bearer.** In substantial systems the subtle body carries *samskaras* across births; in Buddhism a causal stream does the same work without a soul -- showing rebirth needs continuity, not necessarily substance.
- **Scriptural note.** *Gita* 9.21: those who exhaust their merit "return to the world of mortals" -- even heaven is a within-*samsara* stage, confirming that desert keeps the wheel turning.
- **Objection -> reply.** Rebirth is unverifiable and morally hazardous -> reply: untestability is shared with resurrection, and explanatory karma does not license blaming the sufferer.

Verdict. Rebirth is significant in karma theory as the mechanism of discharge: it is what makes moral desert coherent when one life is too short to settle it.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it explains the FUNCTION of rebirth within karma (discharge of desert), not just the fact of it, and adds the continuity point.

Solved PYQ 14 - 2024 Q5(c), 10 marks

Question: Discuss the concept of liberation (*Apavarga*) according to Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika.

Model solution

Thesis. For Nyaya-Vaisesika, liberation (*apavarga*) is the absolute cessation of pain together with the qualities -- including consciousness -- that sustain embodied experience; it is a negative state, not positive bliss.

- **The suffering-chain.** Suffering arises through false knowledge -> defect -> activity -> rebirth -> suffering; true knowledge (*tattva-jnana*) reverses the chain from its root.

- **What liberation is.** The self is an eternal substance to which consciousness is ADVENTITIOUS (arising only through contact with mind and body). In *apavarga* the self persists, but stripped of the nine special qualities including cognition, pleasure and pain -- hence liberation is the end of experience, not its perfection.

- **Distinction.** *Apavarga* differs from positive heavenly pleasure, and from Advaita's blissful *moksa*; it resembles cessation more than fulfilment.

- **Objection -> reply.** A consciousness-less liberation seems undesirable -> reply: Nyaya honestly offers freedom from pain, not a reward; to promise bliss would misdescribe the self.

Verdict. *Apavarga* is the cessation of pain and of the very consciousness that makes pain possible -- the sharpest Indian statement of liberation as release rather than beatitude.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it refuses to sentimentalise *apavarga* as bliss, grounding "no consciousness" in the adventitious-consciousness doctrine.

Solved PYQ 15 - 2024 Q6(a), 20 marks

Question: Is it necessary to adhere to the notions of immortality of soul and rebirth in order to have a robust conception of liberation? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. A robust conception of liberation requires a continuity-bearer that can be bound across lives and then freed -- but it does NOT require an immortal soul-substance; Buddhism shows liberation is coherent on a causal-continuity model.

- **The apparent necessity.** Liberation is exit from bondage-across-lives, so it seems to presuppose (a) rebirth, and (b) something immortal that is liberated. Vedanta, Nyaya and Jainism satisfy both with an eternal *atman/jiva*.

- **The Buddhist case.** *Anatman* + *pratityasamutpada* deliver rebirth and *nirvana* with no permanent self: the stream that was bound is the stream that ceases to crave. So "immortality of soul" is sufficient, not necessary.

- **What IS necessary.** A continuity that can carry desert and then END. Call it substance (substantialists) or stream (Buddhism); either grounds a robust liberation.

- **Objection -> reply.** Without an immortal self, liberation liberates no one -> reply: it liberates the causal series from craving; identity of substance is not required for the coherence of release.

Verdict. Immortality and rebirth are the standard scaffolding of liberation but not its logical minimum; the minimum is a morally continuous subject whose bondage can cease -- which Buddhism secures without an eternal soul.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it gives reasons BOTH ways (as the stem demands), then fixes the exact modal minimum, using Buddhism as the load-bearing case.

Solved PYQ 16 - 2025 Q5(d), 10 marks

Question: Discuss the nature of embodied liberation (jīvanmukti) with reference to Advaita Vedānta.

Model solution

Thesis. *Jivanmukti* in Advaita Vedānta is liberation WHILE EMBODIED: the knower of Brahman is free the moment ignorance is destroyed, though the body continues on residual momentum until death.

- **The doctrine.** *Moksa* is realising *atman* = Brahman by ending *avidya*.

Since bondage is ignorance, liberating knowledge frees IMMEDIATELY -- one need not wait for death.

- **Why the body remains.** Already-fructifying *prarabdha* karma sustains the body, like a potter's wheel that spins on after the hand is withdrawn; accumulated (*sancita*) and future (*agami*) karma are burnt by knowledge. *Videhamukti* follows at the body's fall.

- **Character of the jivanmukta.** Free from egoic appropriation, acting without binding karma, established in Brahman-consciousness now.

- **Objection -> reply.** If knowledge destroys karma, why any embodiment at all?
-> the distinction of *prarabdha* from *sancita/agami* answers exactly this.

Verdict. *Jivanmukti* shows Advaitic liberation is a present cognitive- existential transformation, not a post-mortem place or reward -- freedom is realised, not relocated.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it fixes *jivanmukti* against *videhamukti* and > explains the residual body by *prarabdha*, the exact discriminator examiners want.

Solved PYQ 17 - 2025 Q7(c), 15 marks

Question: Is the concept of immortality of soul a necessary condition for Rebirth? Discuss with reference to the Bhagavad Gītā.

Model solution

Thesis. With reference to the *Bhagavad Gita*, immortality of the soul is presented as the presupposition of rebirth: precisely because the embodied self is imperishable, it "casts off worn-out bodies and enters new ones". Yet, read philosophically, this shows immortality is sufficient for rebirth, not universally necessary.

- **The Gita's teaching.** 2.23 -- weapons, fire, water and wind cannot destroy the self; 2.22 -- the self changes bodies as a person changes worn-out garments. Rebirth here PRESUPPOSES the deathless *atman*.

- **The mechanism.** Driven by karma, the imperishable self takes new embodiments within *samsara*; 9.21 shows even heavenly sojourn ends in return.

- **The wider verdict.** The Gita's model is substantialist, so for IT immortality is necessary. But Buddhism affirms rebirth without an immortal soul, so the necessity is school-relative: the Gita states a sufficient condition, not a law binding every rebirth theory.

- **Objection -> reply.** Does the Gita PROVE immortality? -> No; it ASSERTS it as scriptural teaching and illustrates it (the garment image is illustration, not demonstration).

Verdict. In the Gita, immortality of the soul is the necessary ground of rebirth; across the traditions, it is sufficient but not necessary -- Buddhism is the reservation the honest answer records.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it stays faithful to the NAMED text (Gita verses) while still delivering the modal verdict and the Buddhist reservation.

ORIGINAL MCQ MASTERY SET - EXACTLY 48 QUESTIONS

Questions 1-40 are core coverage - four per subtopic across the ten subtopics; Questions 41-48 are remedial items targeting the most common misreadings. Correct answers rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D 12 times.

MCQ 1

On the six survival-terms, which statement is correct?

A. Rebirth is a wider term than reincarnation. B. Resurrection is a form of transmigration. C. Liberation is simply a synonym for heaven. D. Immortality and survival make exactly the same claim.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Rebirth (esp. Buddhist punarbhava) is the wider term; reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed, resurrection is one life, and liberation is exit from the cycle, not heaven.

MCQ 2

'Immortality of a substantial soul is ____ for rebirth.' The best completion is:

A. necessary and sufficient B. sufficient but not necessary C. necessary but not sufficient D. neither necessary nor sufficient

Correct answer: B

Explanation: A persisting soul would guarantee rebirth (sufficient), but Buddhism shows a soul is not required (not necessary).

MCQ 3

The decisive counter-example to 'rebirth requires an immortal soul' is:

A. Advaita Vedanta B. Nyaya-Vaisesika C. Buddhism D. Jainism

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Buddhism affirms rebirth (punarbhava) while denying a permanent self (anatman).

MCQ 4

Calling 'liberation' a family-resemblance term means:

A. all schools mean the same state by it B. it always denotes union with God C. it is meaningless across schools D. it covers several non-identical destinations that share one label

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Identity, communion, cessation, isolation and perfected individuality share the label 'liberation' without sharing one content.

MCQ 5

Plato's recollection (anamnesis) argument most directly establishes:

A. the soul's pre-existence B. bodily resurrection C. the soul's post-mortem survival on its own D. the mortality of the body

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Recollection infers that the soul knew the Forms before birth -- pre-existence, which is not yet post-mortem survival.

MCQ 6

Which is Plato's culminating ('final') argument in the Phaedo?

A. the affinity argument B. the argument from the Form of Life C. the argument from opposites D. the recollection argument

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The final argument holds that the soul essentially brings Life and so cannot admit its opposite, death.

MCQ 7

Simmias objects to Plato that the soul is:

A. a simple substance B. immortal by affinity to the Forms C. a harmony/attunement of the body D. identical with the Forms

Correct answer: C

Explanation: The harmony objection makes the soul depend on the body; Plato replies the soul rules the body and pre-exists it.

MCQ 8

Kant's paralogism, applied to immortality, shows that:

A. the soul is a knowable substance B. the soul is material C. recollection proves survival D. the soul's permanence cannot be demonstrated as a substance

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Kant denies that the soul is a knowable substance, so its indestructibility cannot be proved a priori.

MCQ 9

The three kinds of karma are:

A. sancita, prarabdha and agami B. asrava, bandha and nirjara C. sattva, rajas and tamas D. jnana, karma and bhakti

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Sancita (stored), prarabdha (now ripening) and agami (future) classify karmic debt.

MCQ 10

Rebirth is significant in karma theory chiefly because it:

A. proves the existence of God B. provides the field in which fruits maturing beyond one life are discharged C. guarantees memory of past lives D. abolishes moral responsibility

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Desert outruns a single life, so rebirth is the field where karmic fruits ripen.

MCQ 11

The claim that karma is NOT fatalism rests on:

A. adrsta alone B. prarabdha alone C. purusakara operating within daiva D. the subtle body

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Personal effort (purasakara) works within the given (daiva); present effort shapes future (agami) karma.

MCQ 12

Gita 9.21 (return from heaven once merit is exhausted) shows that:

A. heaven is final liberation B. resurrection occurs in heaven C. karma is unreal D. even heaven is a within-samsara stage, not liberation

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Heavenly sojourn ends in return to the mortal world, so it is inside samsara.

MCQ 13

In Buddhism, what is 'reborn' is best described as:

A. a dependently arisen causal stream B. an eternal atman C. a transmigrating substance D. a resurrected body

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Rebirth is causal continuity of dependently arisen aggregates, not a soul.

MCQ 14

'Neither the same nor wholly other' answers the objection that:

A. Buddhism is nihilist B. if no self persists, who receives the karmic fruit? C. the flame analogy is a proof D. anatman denies conventional persons

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The later stream is causally descended from the earlier -- enough for moral responsibility without substance-identity.

MCQ 15

The flame-to-flame illustration is properly used as:

A. a proof of rebirth B. a proof of anatman C. a model of continuity without numerical identity D. evidence of an immortal soul

Correct answer: C

Explanation: It illustrates a continuity-model; it is never a demonstration.

MCQ 16

The philosophical significance of the anti-theistic stand on rebirth is that rebirth is shown to be:

A. impossible without God B. identical to resurrection C. dependent on an immortal soul D. separable from both a creator-God and a soul-substance

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Buddhism (and Jainism) run karma-rebirth-liberation without a judging God or a transmigrating substance.

MCQ 17

In Nyaya apavarga, consciousness in the liberated state is:

A. absent B. infinite bliss C. non-dual awareness D. omniscient

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Consciousness is adventitious to the Nyaya self, so apavarga ends pain and consciousness alike -- a negative state.

MCQ 18

Which pair correctly matches liberation-term to school?

A. kaivalya -- Advaita B. apavarga -- Nyaya-Vaisesika C. nirvana -- Jainism D. moksa -- Buddhism

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Apavarga is the Nyaya-Vaisesika term; kaivalya is Samkhya-Yoga, nirvana is Buddhist, and Buddhism does not use moksa in the Vedantic sense.

MCQ 19

Jivanmukti differs from videhamukti in that jivanmukti is:

A. liberation only after death B. liberation of the body itself C. liberation attained while still embodied D. the resurrection of the person

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Jivanmukti is freedom while living; videhamukti is at the body's fall.

MCQ 20

Griffiths' formula that Advaitic moksa is 'not acquired but acknowledged' means:

A. moksa is produced by ritual action B. moksa is a future heavenly reward C. moksa requires bodily resurrection D. liberation removes an error and the self was free all along

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Bondage is avidya/adhyasa, so knowledge only removes the superimposition.

MCQ 21

For Visistadvaita, in liberation the jiva:

A. persists eternally in communion with God B. becomes numerically identical with Brahman C. is annihilated D. loses all consciousness

Correct answer: A

Explanation: The jiva is an eternal mode of God, freed into service/communion, never becoming God.

MCQ 22

The 'real agent' problem is a difficulty primarily for:

A. Visistadvaita B. Advaita C. Nyaya D. Jainism

Correct answer: B

Explanation: If ultimate individuality is denied, Advaita must explain who is bound and freed; it appeals to conventional agency until insight.

MCQ 23

In Advaita, bondage is fundamentally:

A. karmic matter clinging to the soul B. dependence on God C. avidya, a beginningless superimposition (adhyasa) D. the isolation of purusa from prakrti

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Bondage is ignorance -- the rope-snake superimposition -- removable only by knowledge.

MCQ 24

For Sankara, the direct means to liberation is:

A. karma alone B. bhakti as prapatti C. ritual injunction D. jnana, because bondage is ignorance

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Since liberation is the removal of avidya, only knowledge removes it; Sankara rejects jnana-karma-samuccaya.

MCQ 25

In Jainism, the influx of karmic matter into the soul is called:

A. asrava B. samvara C. nirjara D. bandha

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Asrava is influx; bandha is bondage, samvara is stoppage, nirjara is shedding.

MCQ 26

The stoppage of fresh karmic influx is:

A. asrava B. samvara C. nirjara D. kevala

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Samvara halts new influx; nirjara then sheds accumulated matter.

MCQ 27

Jain liberation is best described as:

A. identity with Brahman B. cessation of the causal stream C. perfected omniscient individuality D. contentless isolation of purusa

Correct answer: C

Explanation: The freed jiva manifests ananta-catustaya (infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, energy) -- individuality perfected, not dissolved.

MCQ 28

Jain kevala differs from Samkhya kaivalya because Jain kevala means:

A. contentless isolation B. cessation of consciousness C. union with a personal God D. omniscience (kevala-jnana)

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Same syllable, opposite content: Jain kevala is omniscience; Samkhya kaivalya is contentless isolation.

MCQ 29

Samkhya-karika 62-63 states that, strictly, what is bound and released is:

A. prakrti, not purusa B. purusa, not prakrti C. Isvara D. the individual buddhi acting alone

Correct answer: A

Explanation: No purusa is bound, released or transmigrating; prakrti binds and releases herself -- the misattribution is the whole doctrine.

MCQ 30

The potter's-wheel image (SK 67) illustrates:

- A. the creation of the world B. the body persisting on residual momentum after discriminative knowledge C. the plurality of purusas D. Isvara as creator

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The wheel spins on after the hand withdraws -- like the body after viveka-khyati; it parallels Advaita's prarabdha image.

MCQ 31

Yoga-sutra 1.24 characterises Isvara as:

- A. the material cause of the world B. the karmic judge of souls C. a special purusa untouched by karma D. identical with prakrti

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Isvara is a special purusa, object of pranidhana -- theism without creation.

MCQ 32

Samkhya-Yoga kaivalya is best described as:

- A. identity with Brahman B. communion with a personal God C. omniscient perfection D. the isolation of contentless pure consciousness

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Kaivalya is aloneness -- purusa standing in its own nature, explicitly not bliss.

MCQ 33

The nine limbs of devotion (navadha bhakti) are enumerated in:

- A. Bhagavata Purana 7.5.23 B. Bhagavad Gita 18.66 C. Yoga-sutra 1.24 D. Samkhya-karika 62

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Bhagavata 7.5.23 lists sravana, kirtana, smarana, pada-sevana, arcana, vandana, dasya, sakhya, atma-nivedana.

MCQ 34

Sankara rejects jnana-karma-samuccaya because he holds that liberation is:

- A. produced by action B. the removal of ignorance, not a produced effect C. a graded combination of all means D. attained by ritual alone

Correct answer: B

Explanation: On the removal model, only knowledge dispels avidya; action merely purifies.

MCQ 35

The marjara-nyaya versus markata-nyaya dispute concerns:

- A. the reality of the world B. the number of purusas C. the relation of grace and effort in liberation D. the correct definition of karma

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Cat-hold (grace alone) versus monkey-hold (grace plus effort) is the tradition's own statement of the grace-effort problem.

MCQ 36

The Vivekacudamani definition of bhakti should be attributed to:

A. Sankara personally B. Ramanuja C. Madhva D. the Advaita tradition, since the ascription to Sankara is disputed

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Provenance discipline: say 'the Advaita tradition', never 'Sankara wrote'.

MCQ 37

Oscar Cullmann (1955) argues that immortality of the soul and resurrection of the dead are:

A. theologically opposed, not complementary B. two names for one doctrine C. both Greek in origin D. both forms of rebirth

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Cullmann's thesis is that the Greek and Hebrew-Christian conceptions are opposed.

MCQ 38

'Reincarnation', in careful usage, differs from 'rebirth' because reincarnation:

A. applies straightforwardly to Buddhism B. presupposes a substantial soul re-entering flesh C. denies any continuity between lives D. is the wider, more neutral term

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed; rebirth is wider and the only correct term for Buddhism.

MCQ 39

Hick's replica theory is best presented as:

A. a proof of the soul's natural immortality B. a Vedantic doctrine of liberation C. a thought-experiment defence of resurrection identity D. a denial of personal identity

Correct answer: C

Explanation: An exact, unique psychophysical replica is argued to be the same person; the duplication objection is the standard reply.

MCQ 40

Which reply to the resurrection re-assembly problem is correctly paired?

A. Hick -- the soul is the form of the body B. Aquinas -- an exact replica in another space C. Cullmann -- God substitutes a simulacrum D. van Inwagen -- God preserves a core of the body

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Aquinas = soul as form; Hick = replica; van Inwagen = God preserves a core or leaves a simulacrum.

Remedial MCQ 41

A common error is to say Buddhism denies continuity. Correctly, Buddhism denies:

A. a permanent substance-self, not continuity B. rebirth altogether C. moral responsibility D. causation of any kind

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Anatman denies a permanent self, while the causal stream secures continuity.

Remedial MCQ 42

A frequent trap calls Nyaya apavarga 'positive bliss'. Correctly, apavarga is:

A. union with a personal God B. the cessation of pain and of consciousness C. omniscient perfection D. the isolation of purusa

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Consciousness is adventitious to the Nyaya self, so apavarga is release from pain, not beatitude.

Remedial MCQ 43

Students merge kaivalya and kevala. In Samkhya kaivalya is ____; in Jainism kevala is ____:

A. omniscience; contentless isolation B. bliss; cessation C. contentless isolation; omniscience D. communion; identity

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Same syllable, opposite content -- Samkhya isolation versus Jain omniscience.

Remedial MCQ 44

It is wrong to say 'Advaita rejects bhakti'. Advaita treats bhakti as:

A. the direct means to moksa B. a fifth purusartha above liberation C. wholly irrelevant to liberation D. preparatory (citta-suddhi), qualifying one for jnana

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Bhakti is a difference of ROLE, not of value: it purifies and qualifies, and jnana alone removes ignorance.

Remedial MCQ 45

The best correction to 'all Indian liberation is merger with God' is that it is false for:

A. Nyaya, Samkhya and Buddhism B. Advaita and Visistadvaita C. Jainism only D. no school at all

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Nyaya apavarga, Samkhya kaivalya and Buddhist nirvana involve no merger with God.

Remedial MCQ 46

Presenting resurrection as 'rebirth in heaven' is wrong because resurrection is:

A. a beginningless karmic series B. one life, a bodily re-constitution by divine act, with final judgement C. driven by karma maturing across lives D. an exit from samsara

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Resurrection is the opposite structure to samsara: linear, eschatological, and divinely enacted.

Remedial MCQ 47

The 'convergence' reading of jnana/karma/bhakti is best defended by saying they converge in ____ and diverge in ____:

A. terminus; function B. text; author C. function; terminus D. grace; effort

Correct answer: C

Explanation: They converge in function (removing egoic self-appropriation) but diverge in terminus (identity vs communion).

Remedial MCQ 48

Calling Yoga's Isvara a 'creator' is a trap; YS 1.24 makes Isvara:

A. the material cause of the world B. the karmic judge of all souls C. numerically identical with Brahman D. a special purusa, object of pranidhana, not the ground of the world

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Yoga is the decisive Indian case of theism without creation.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Three original questions authored for this package (not PYQs), one each at 10, 15 and 20 marks, with full model solutions.

Original Mains 1

Original question | Philosophy Paper II, Philosophy of Religion | 10 marks | answer in ~150 words

Question: Distinguish rebirth from reincarnation, and explain why the distinction is decisive for Buddhism.

Model solution

Thesis. Rebirth is the wider, more neutral term; reincarnation is the narrower term that assumes a substantial soul re-entering flesh -- which is why Buddhism accepts rebirth but not reincarnation.

- **Reincarnation** (*re-enfleshing*) presupposes an enduring soul-substance that passes from body to body; it fits Vedanta, Nyaya and Jainism.

- **Rebirth** (*punarjanma/punarbhava*) names only re-becoming within *samsara*, and can be cashed out with or without a substance.

- **Why decisive for Buddhism.** Buddhism affirms *punarbhava* while denying a permanent self (*anatman*); what continues is a dependently arisen causal stream

(flame-to-flame), "neither the same nor wholly other". To call this "reincarnation" would smuggle back the very soul-substance Buddhism denies.

Verdict. Use "rebirth" as the genus and reserve "reincarnation" for the substantialist species; only then is Buddhist *punarbhava* correctly described.

Original Mains 2

Original question | Philosophy Paper II, Philosophy of Religion | 15 marks | answer in ~250 words

Question: Examine whether 'liberation' can be treated as a single concept across the Indian schools.

Model solution

Thesis. 'Liberation' is a family-resemblance term, not a single concept: once the school-specific destinations are separated, the apparent Indian consensus turns out to be a shared vocabulary covering incompatible states.

- **The parity bench.** *Moksa* (Advaita) is realised identity with Brahman; *moksa* (Visistadvaita) is eternal communion with God; *apavarga* (Nyaya) is cessation of pain AND of consciousness; *kaivalya* (Samkhya-Yoga) is the isolation of contentless consciousness; *kevala/siddhatva* (Jain) is perfected omniscient individuality; *nirvana* (Buddhism) is the cessation of craving with

no self affirmed.

- **The consciousness test.** These states differ precisely on what survives:

Nyaya keeps a self but no consciousness; Advaita keeps non-dual bliss; Samkhya keeps contentless awareness; Jainism keeps omniscience; Buddhism affirms no self. A single concept cannot span "no consciousness" and "infinite bliss".

- **What they share.** Only a formal core: cessation of bondage and exit from *samsara*. That is a family resemblance, not a common essence.

- **Objection -> reply.** Perhaps all are "freedom from suffering"? Reply: even this masks a production/removal split and the identity/isolation divide.

Verdict. Treat 'liberation' as a genus with irreducibly different species; fixing the exact term against the parity bench is the first task in any answer.

Original Mains 3

Original question | Philosophy Paper II, Philosophy of Religion | 20 marks | answer in ~400 words

Question: Compare the Western resurrection tradition and the Indian rebirth tradition on the problem of personal identity across death.

Model solution

Thesis. Resurrection and rebirth answer different questions and face the identity problem from opposite directions; neither is a version of the other, and on both the question "is the later being the SAME?" remains unresolved.

- **Two structures.** Resurrection (Hebrew-Christian-Islamic) is ONE life: the person is a psychosomatic unity, so survival needs God to re-constitute the whole person, and history ends in judgement. Rebirth (Indian) is a beginningless series in which karma matures across lives until liberation. Oscar Cullmann (1955) argues Greek immortality and Hebrew resurrection are theologically OPPOSED, not complementary.

- **Identity for resurrection.** The gap problem (what exists between death and resurrection?) and the re-assembly ("cannibal") problem (shared atoms) threaten bodily continuity. Standard replies: Aquinas -- the rational soul is the FORM of the body and secures continuity; van Inwagen -- God preserves a core of the body or leaves a simulacrum; Hick -- an exact, unique psychophysical replica, continuous in memory and character, is the same person for all that matters. The duplication objection (God could make two) says the criterion is then not identity.

- **Book support.** Lynne Rudder Baker ("Death and the Afterlife", Oxford Handbook of Philosophy of Religion) sets out four candidate criteria -- same soul, same body, same composite, or continuity of memory -- and surveys Origen's "seed", Augustine's re-collected "statue" and Aquinas's soul-as-form; Bernard Williams's reduplication argument and H. H. Price's image-world sharpen the difficulty.

- **Identity for rebirth.** The memory objection (no recollection of prior lives) is met by distinguishing psychological memory from metaphysical continuity and appealing to latent *samskaras*; in Buddhism identity is dropped altogether in favour of a causal stream "neither the same nor wholly other".

- **Contrast.** Resurrection keeps the body essential; rebirth discards it like a garment (*Gita* 2.22). Resurrection needs a divine agent; rebirth needs only the self-regulating law of karma.

Verdict. Resurrection asks how an essentially embodied person can survive; rebirth asks how moral desert can be discharged when one life is too short. Both leave the sameness of the later being contested -- for resurrection because of the gap and duplication, for rebirth because of the missing memory and (in Buddhism) the deliberate abandonment of numerical identity.